CONNECT WEEKLY

Issue 10 · week ending Friday 13 November 2026
themapsproject.com

A weekly review of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear "so what for your school" line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, get in touch.

TOP LINE

- A genuinely quiet week for new national policy: nothing fresh on SEND reform, exclusions guidance or Ofsted's framework beyond last week's committee hearing. What did land was more operational — a six-monthly Ofsted statistics refresh, an escalating sixth-form college pay dispute, and two live Sheffield stories: a strike at a council-maintained SEND school and a secondary-places funding decision due at next week's council meeting.

  → **For your school:** *No single big-ticket item to action nationally this week — but see the Sheffield section below, since both local stories are the kind governors and SLT get asked about directly.*

- Ofsted's twice-yearly statistics release, updated 10 November, gives the first reasonably full look at outcomes under the renewed inspection framework that came into force a year ago — covering provisional data for April to August 2026 alongside revised figures back to November 2025. We haven't been able to verify the headline outcome percentages from the published tables at the time of writing, so treat any breakdown you see quoted elsewhere with care until you've checked the source directly.

  → **For your school:** *If your trust wants a view on how the new framework's first full year is landing, pull the data from the GOV.UK release directly rather than relying on secondary write-ups.*

- The sixth-form college pay dispute escalated this week, with FE Week reporting four more strike dates lodged on 8 November after the NEU rejected the Sixth Form Colleges' Association's 3.5% offer for 2026/27. A union-commissioned survey found over three-quarters of sixth-form college teachers would back strike action, with the underlying grievance a pay gap between sixth-form college and school-based teachers that's persisted for years despite repeated pay-restoration pledges.

  → **For your school:** *If your school runs 16-19 provision or shares staff or partnership arrangements with a sixth-form college, flag the dispute to whoever manages those relationships — more strike days are now locked in.*

- Nothing new on SEND this week since last week's committee hearing confirmed the reform legislation's slip to early next year. The one live, actionable thread is the DfE's call for evidence on exclusion reform — covering internal suspension, reintegration partnerships and day-one schoolwork — which closes 19 November.

  → **For your school:** *If your trust hasn't yet submitted a view on the exclusion reform call for evidence, this is the week to do it — the window closes next Wednesday.*

DATES FOR THE DIARY

16 Nov 2026 — Sheffield City Council's policy committee due to decide on ~£1.1m funding to temporarily expand Hinde House School by 90 places.

16 Nov 2026 — Free breakfast clubs attendance monitoring form opens, covering the 9-13 November census week; closes 4 December.

16-20 Nov 2026 — Anti-Bullying Week 2026, theme 'Break the Silence', opens with Odd Socks Day on the Monday.

19 Nov 2026 — DfE's call for evidence on exclusion reform (internal suspension, reintegration partnerships,

day-one schoolwork) closes.

Nov 2026 (exact day tbc) — DfE due to publish autumn 2025/26 suspensions and permanent exclusions statistics for England.

15 Dec 2026 — NEU's formal strike ballot of teachers and support staff over pay, funding and workload closes.

OFSTED & ACCOUNTABILITY

▪ **Ofsted's stats refresh lands quietly, giving the first full-year view under the renewed framework.** GOV.UK's 'state-funded schools inspections and outcomes' release was updated on 10 November, combining provisional inspection outcomes for April to August 2026 with revised data stretching back to when the renewed Education Inspection Framework came into force on 10 November 2025. It's the first release letting anyone compare a genuinely full cycle of inspections under the new report-card system against the old one — useful context for last week's revelation that Powell wants inspection consequences to change for high-SEND-cohort schools. We weren't able to confirm specific outcome percentages from the published tables in time for this edition, so treat any headline figures quoted elsewhere this week with caution until checked against the source. (GOV.UK)

→ **For your school:** *Worth pulling the actual tables if your trust is building a case on how the new framework is landing for schools with large SEND cohorts — don't rely on secondary commentary this week.*

WORKFORCE, PAY & INDUSTRIAL ACTION

▪ **Sixth-form college teachers add four more strike dates in an escalating pay dispute.** FE Week reported on 8 November that NEU members at sixth-form colleges have lodged four additional strike dates, after rejecting the Sixth Form Colleges' Association's 3.5% pay offer for 2026/27. A separate union-commissioned survey found more than three-quarters of sixth-form college teachers would support strike action — a figure worth treating as indicative rather than an official turnout result, since it comes from campaign research rather than a formal ballot. The underlying grievance, a persistent pay gap between sixth-form college and school-based teachers, sits alongside the broader NEU pay-and-funding ballot of school staff that remains open until 15 December. (FE Week)

→ **For your school:** *Relevant mainly if you run or partner with 16-19 provision — check whether any shared staffing or timetabling arrangements are exposed to the new strike dates.*

SEND, INCLUSION & BEHAVIOUR

▪ **A quiet week on substance, but the exclusion reform window is closing.** Nothing new has surfaced on SEND system reform since last week's committee hearing confirmed the legislative slip to early 2027, and there's no fresh movement on behaviour or exclusions guidance either. The one thing actually moving is the clock: the DfE's call for evidence on exclusion reform — covering internal suspension, reintegration partnerships and day-one schoolwork for suspended pupils — closes on 19 November, after which the department will presumably start shaping its response. (GOV.UK)

→ **For your school:** *If you or your trust has a view on internal suspension or reintegration partnerships, this is genuinely the last practical week to get it in before the call for evidence closes.*

ATTENDANCE & FUNDING

▪ **Breakfast club census week falls this week — and funding depends on it.** Schools in the free breakfast clubs programme are required to record daily attendance for Reception to Year 6 during this year's census week, which runs 9-13 November; the monitoring form built on that data opens 16 November and closes 4 December. Per-pupil funding under the scheme is calculated from average recorded attendance, and DfE guidance warns that submissions made after the closing date delay payment by a further term — so this has become a funding deadline as much as a pastoral one. (GOV.UK)

→ **For your school:** *If your setting runs the free breakfast clubs programme, check this week that registers are being completed properly — a missed or late submission costs a term's funding.*

SAFEGUARDING & WELLBEING

- **Anti-Bullying Week 2026 arrives next week, themed 'Break the Silence'.** The Anti-Bullying Alliance's Anti-Bullying Week runs 16-20 November, opening with Odd Socks Day on the Monday; this year's theme highlights children who suffer bullying without telling anyone. There's no new DfE guidance attached to it this year, so it's a campaign and assembly-planning moment for pastoral teams rather than a policy one — but it sits naturally alongside KCSIE 2026's rewritten mental health section, which already asks schools to take a more whole-school approach to emotional wellbeing. (National Children's Bureau)

  → **For your school:** *Worth getting assembly and PSHE materials for Anti-Bullying Week into pastoral teams' hands this week if that hasn't happened already.*

SHEFFIELD & SOUTH YORKSHIRE

- **Strike action continues at Talbot Specialist School.** NEU members at Talbot Specialist School, a council-maintained SEND school in Norton Lees, walked out on 5 November in a dispute over workload, safety and staffing levels, with the union citing a failure by the school to engage in meaningful talks; further strike days are planned across the rest of November. Unlike most Sheffield secondaries, Talbot sits under direct council control rather than an academy trust, which puts the dispute squarely in the council's lap rather than a trust's. (The Star)

  → **For your school:** *Worth watching if your trust has SEND provision staffed similarly, since workload and safety are the specific grounds cited — not pay.*

- **Council set to approve funding for a secondary-places expansion.** Sheffield City Council's policy committee is due to decide on 16 November whether to approve around £1.1m to temporarily expand Hinde House School in Shiregreen by 90 places, one of several moves the council is considering to meet a forecast shortage of secondary places running to 2029. It's the latest instalment in a running theme for Sheffield this year — place-planning pressure building faster than permanent capacity can be added, with temporary expansions used as the stopgap. (The Star)

  → **For your school:** *Worth knowing if your catchment overlaps with north Sheffield — this is the clearest sign yet of where the council expects pressure to land first.*

DATA POINT OF THE WEEK

75%+

More than three-quarters of sixth-form college teachers say they'd back strike action over pay, per a union-commissioned survey reported this week — though as campaign research rather than a formal ballot result, it's a sentiment figure, not an official turnout number. It's the backdrop to the four new strike dates NEU members at sixth-form colleges lodged on 8 November.

The Star / FE Week, 8 November 2026

MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. Explore School+

SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		

Source	Type	What we track
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?"
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Weekly is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.